

Question:

A mental health volunteer is interviewing locals as part of a community outreach program. A 46-year-old man discloses that he has felt sad for as long as he can remember. He feels as though his life is cursed and if something terrible can happen to him, it usually will. He has difficulty making decisions and feels hopeless. He also feels that he has had worsening suicidal ideations, guilt from past problems, energy, and concentration over the past 2 weeks. He is otherwise getting enough sleep and able to hold a job. Which of the following statement best describes this patient's condition?

Answer Choices:

- A. The patient is at risk for double depression.
- B. The patient may have symptoms of mania or psychosis.
- C. The patient is likely to show anhedonia.
- D. The patient likely has paranoid personality disorder.

Reasoning + Answer:

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The patient's symptoms of persistent sadness, feelings of hopelessness, difficulty making decisions, worsening suicidal ideations, and guilt from past problems suggest a depressive disorder. The presence of these symptoms, especially the duration and severity, is indicative of Major Depressive Disorder (MDD). The patient's ability to hold a job and get enough sleep despite these symptoms does not rule out MDD, as individuals with MDD can still function normally in some aspects of their lives. The patient's beliefs about being cursed and expecting terrible things to happen may be a manifestation of depressive cognitions, which are common in MDD. The patient's symptoms have been present for a long time and have worsened over the past 2 weeks, indicating a possible episode of depression. The patient's condition does not appear to be related to mania or psychosis, as there is no mention of manic or psychotic symptoms such as delusions or hallucinations. The patient's symptoms also do not align with paranoid personality disorder, as this condition is characterized by a pervasive pattern of distrust and suspiciousness, which is not explicitly mentioned in the scenario. The patient's symptoms are more indicative of a depressive disorder, and the term "double depression" refers to the co-occurrence of MDD and dysthymia, which is a chronic depressive disorder. The patient's symptoms are more consistent with a major depressive episode, and the term "double depression" does not accurately describe this patient's condition. Anhedonia is a common symptom of depression, and the patient's symptoms are consistent with this condition. </think><answer> C. The patient likely has anhedonia.

